

Ozone hole reduces

Over Antarctica, the ozone layer seems to be on a road to recovery, as observers pegged its ozone layer hole to be smallest in a decade



Curiosity drills into Mars

For the first time ever, Curiosity stuck the drill at the end of its robotic arm into Martian surface to collect and analyze soil samples. <http://dgit.in/Xt4BHd>



HTC Desire SV

also feels better built. The rear however has a white glossy finish making it a bit of a fingerprint magnet. The Micromax A90S has borrowed its looks and design from the Samsung Galaxy S II. The capacitive navigation buttons on its body are a part of the display just like the Nexus and not below the display like we have seen on other devices. The rear has a textured finish just like the S II. The device is lighter than other smartphones in its category.

The Spice Stellar Pinnacle is the second largest phone in our list. It has a 5.3-inch display and reminds us of the first generation Galaxy Note. The device has a design ideal for two hand use and will definitely bulge out of your jeans pocket.

The largest phone in our shootout, the Karbonn A30 has a 5.9-inch display. You will need two hands to operate this device

all the time and don't expect it to fit in your pocket with ease either. The design is great for one who needs to consume a lot of multimedia content or browse the Internet and read a lot of text on it.

Features and Performance

The three Lumia devices run on the Windows Phone 7.5 operating system. All the other devices run on Android 4.0 ICS except the Micromax A116 Canvas HD and the iBall Andi 4.5q that runs on Android 4.1 Jelly Bean.

All the devices here are capable of running almost all the apps from their respective apps store. Here we will talk about the unique features and general performance of the featured smartphones.

The Videocon A30 has a skin overlaying Android and

this may not appeal to all. The lock screen gives users access to calls, camera, and messages. The device isn't the best when it comes to multitasking, and can be considered as your most basic Android experience, based on our performance tests.

The Karbonn A9+ and the A21 are the same when it comes to the preloaded skin and the everyday performance. Where we like the A21 over the A9+ is the feel of the touchscreen and the overall user experience. The device feels a hair smoother and the 0.5-inch larger screen size is always welcome.

The Xolo X500 is one device that we are really impressed with. It is a very smooth device to use. The screen size may be small for most to use but the display does have great viewing angles. The X500 is an Intel Atom powered device and the hardware has seriously impressed us in the benchmark scores. This is the second device to be powered by Intel's hardware and we wish the display were bigger so that we could

enjoy multimedia and apps more and push the hardware to its limits.

The Sony Xperia Tipo comes with the timescape UI but the overall experience of the device is lacklustre. The icons don't look sharp and the small display is a hindrance with web browsing as well as running apps. The display is small for multimedia consumption, too.

The Intex Aqua 5 comes with stock Android. Interestingly, the Aqua 5 comes with an app called the Intex Zone that lets you record calls as well as track your phone. It also links to certain useful Intex Mobile websites for customer service. Its extra features aren't as extensive as the one available on the Micromax A110. Other preloaded apps include Flipkart, NQ Mobile security and IRCTC.

The Nokia Lumia 510, 610 and the 710 are absolutely the same in their interface and performance. The resolution of the display too is at par, though the pixel density varies a bit. The Lumia 710 is the most powerful



LG Optimus L9